

Cliffords Inn

No. 107

THE HERITAGE of FLEET STREET

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The Hall of the original Cliffords Inn



Cliffords Inn Gatehouse



View from the tower of St Dunstan in the West

Clifford's Inn dates back to 1344, when it became an Inn of Chancery, providing accommodation and legal education for students before they moved on to the Inns of Court.

The original Inn stretched from Fetter Lane to Chancery Lane, with its entrance from Fleet Street. The old gatehouse in Clifford's Inn Passage is the only part of the original buildings that survives.

After the Great Fire of 1666, the Fire Court met here to settle disputes about rebuilding London.

Clifford's Inn also had many literary connections. Charles Dickens mentioned it in three novels, while Leonard and Virginia Woolf lived there briefly in 1912.

The buildings eventually fell into disrepair. In 1934, most were demolished and the site was redeveloped. The present eight-storey building contains offices and more than 100 flats.